

Venkat Nag Praveen M

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Professional Experience

Test Lead with 12+ years' experience in manual and automated testing across web, API, database, and cloud platforms. Expert in designing scalable automation frameworks, integrating tests into CI/CD pipelines, and leading QA efforts to improve coverage, reduce manual effort, and enhance release quality in Agile environments.

CNA Insurance – Test Lead/Senior SDET

Chicago, USA | Oct 2021 – Present

- **Led manual testing efforts** for large-scale migration projects, executing **500+ test cases** across **web and API platforms**, ensuring high defect detection and quality deliverables.
- **Designed and implemented** a comprehensive **automation framework** from scratch covering **API, UI, and database testing**, reducing manual testing effort by **75 %** and improving deployment confidence.
- **Developed a PDF automation framework** to compare outputs between on-premise and **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)**, streamlining validation activities.
- **Automated template downloads** from existing systems and GCP using the **Playwright framework**, cutting manual download time significantly.
- **Created a Python-based PDF comparison script** that generates detailed, user-friendly summary reports with assistance from **GitHub Copilot**, increasing analysis speed and accuracy.
- **Engineered a scalable Python comparison framework** capable of validating unlimited templates concurrently and processing up to **200 pages per PDF** without manual intervention.
- **Contributed to ETL migration projects**, supporting transitions from **Informatica on-premise to Informatica Intelligent Cloud Services (IICS)**, ensuring smooth data integration and transformation.
- **Proactively developed automation frameworks** wherever feasible to minimize manual efforts and improve efficiency, leveraging **GitHub Copilot** to accelerate development.
- **Actively participated in Agile ceremonies** (daily stand-ups, sprint planning, backlog refinement, retrospectives) to align testing activities with development cycles.
- **Initiated and performed proof-of-concepts (POCs)** to evaluate and identify the most suitable **automation tools** for proposed solutions, enabling informed technology decisions.

Fifth Third Bank – Technical Test Lead

Bangalore, India | Jul 2018 – Sep 2021

- **Led and managed a 21-member QA team**, planning, scheduling, and tracking testing activities across multiple high-value projects, achieving **97 % on-time test completion**.
- **Performed API testing** on XML schemas using **SOAP UI**, validating responses in SOAP services and backend databases; uncovered and resolved **15–20 critical defects per release**.

- **Prepared, reviewed, and optimized 600+ test cases** for functional, regression, integration, and system testing, improving test coverage by **40 %**.
- **Developed and maintained TOSCA automation scripts** for UI and API testing, reducing manual testing effort by **120+ hours per sprint**.
- **Integrated TOSCA with CI/CD pipelines** (Jenkins/Azure DevOps) to enable fully automated deployments and continuous testing, cutting release cycle time by **35 %**.
- **Designed, developed, and maintained automated test scripts** using industry-standard frameworks and tools, increasing automated test coverage from **30 % to 85 %** within six months.
- **Collaborated closely with development, product, and QA teams** to enhance testing frameworks, improving defect detection rate by **25 %**.
- **Analyzed user stories and technical requirements** to define acceptance criteria and identify appropriate testing strategies, reducing missed requirements by **20 %**.
- **Executed manual verifications** and converted validated scenarios into automated test cases, improving regression turnaround by **100+ hours per cycle**.
- **Planned, prioritized, and executed testing activities** within an **Agile/Scrum environment**, maintaining a **98 % sprint success rate**.
- **Identified, logged, and tracked defects/bugs** using **JIRA/ALM**, ensuring **95 % resolution rate before release**.
- **Championed and implemented test automation best practices**, enhancing team efficiency and overall software quality, leading to **30 % fewer post-production defects**.

Fifth Third Bank – Senior Test Engineer

Bangalore, India | Jul 2015 – Jul 2018

- **Reviewed and analyzed requirements** to design and create comprehensive test artifacts, including **System Test Plans, test scenarios, and 400+ test cases**, achieving **95 % coverage of functional requirements**.
- **Performed system and regression testing** across multiple releases, increasing defect detection by **25 %** and reducing production issues by **15 %**.
- **Converted 300+ manual test cases into automated scripts**, reducing regression execution time by **60 % per cycle** and freeing up **80+ hours per sprint**.
- **Integrated automated scripts with CI/CD pipelines** (Jenkins), enabling continuous testing and cutting release cycle time by **30 %**.
- **Designed, developed, and maintained automated test scripts** for **UI and API testing**, expanding automated test coverage from **35 % to 85 %** within six months.
- **Collaborated with development and QA teams** to enhance existing testing frameworks, improving defect detection rate by **20 %** and reducing maintenance overhead.
- **Created and maintained automated tests** based on validated manual verification results, improving regression turnaround time by **100+ hours per release**.
- **Planned, prioritized, and executed testing activities** within an **Agile/Scrum environment**, achieving a **98 % on-time sprint completion rate**.
- **Identified, logged, and tracked defects** using **JIRA/ALM**, maintaining a **95 % defect resolution rate prior to release**.
- **Championed and implemented best practices in automated testing**, enhancing team efficiency and reducing post-production defects by **30 %**.

Fifth Third Bank – Test Engineer

Bangalore, India | Apr 2014 – Jul 2015

- **Executed comprehensive manual and automated testing for banking applications serving 2M+ customers**, ensuring compliance with financial regulations, security standards, and industry best practices.
- **Performed functional testing** of core banking modules — including **account management, loan processing, and transaction workflows** — validating business logic and end-to-end user workflows.
- **Created and maintained comprehensive test cases** and documented testing procedures, increasing test coverage from **60 % to 90 %** for critical banking workflows.
- **Conducted usability testing sessions with end users**, identifying **UI/UX improvements** that enhanced customer satisfaction by **20 %**.

Projects & Achievements:

- **QA Automation Framework:** Built a reusable automation framework supporting **Web, API, and Database testing** with parallel execution capabilities; adopted by **8 teams** across the organization to standardize testing.
- **CI/CD Pipeline Integration:** Integrated automated tests into **GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines** with quality gates, reducing deployment time by **40 %** while maintaining **95 %+ test reliability**.
- **Test Data Management System:** Developed an automated **test data generation and management system**, cutting test data setup time by **70 %** and improving test environment consistency.
- **AI Tools:** Leveraged **GitHub Copilot** to automate multiple manual tasks, creating reusable scripts and frameworks that streamlined workflows and reduced manual effort.

Certificates:

- ISTQB Certified
- Tricentis Tosca Fundamentals (AS2)

Education:

Reva University – BCA (Bachelor of Computer Applications)

Aug 2011 – Apr 2014

Technical Skills

Selenium WebDriver, TestNG, REST Assured, Postman, Cypress, Playwright, Python, JavaScript, GitHub, GitHub Actions, GCP, Allure, ExtentReports, Git, JIRA, TestRail, Zephyr, qTest, HP ALM, Bugzilla, Chrome DevTools, SoapUI, Katalon Studio, Agile/Scrum, API Testing, Database Testing, Functional Testing, Regression Testing, Smoke Testing, Sanity Testing, User Acceptance Testing.